

# INTERNATIONAL LANGUAGES

## OVERVIEW

In courses in international languages, students develop their listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills in order to communicate in the language of study (the target language) in a variety of contexts and for a variety of purposes, with a focus on real-life situations and uses. Through their exploration of a wide variety of authentic materials and meaningful activities, students develop not only language skills but also the skills necessary for lifelong language learning. They also acquire an understanding and appreciation of diverse communities around the world where the target language is spoken, and make connections to their own community.

Language structures and conventions that are appropriate for each level are listed in the Language Knowledge chart for international languages that is provided in Appendix B. Students should be given ample opportunities to demonstrate and extend their understanding of the language elements by applying them in a wide variety of contexts across the strands. Two additional charts are provided to assist teachers in planning learning activities – Topics for Developing Vocabulary, and Cultural Concepts for Developing Intercultural Understanding.

The expectations for courses in international languages are organized into four distinct but related strands:

### Listening

Oral communication skills lay the foundation for the acquisition of any new language, and pave the way for learning to read and write in that language. Well-developed listening skills are essential for students' development of the proficiency in the target language that they will need to succeed in the program. To develop their listening and interaction skills, international language learners need extensive opportunities to listen to and interact with others. They also need to develop listening skills in order to understand what is said during classroom presentations, in radio and television broadcasts, and in many other contexts. At first, students listen to directions and instructions; as they progress, they are able to take point-form notes in class; and eventually, they are able to provide a summary of a presentation.

International language learners need many opportunities to listen to a range of subjects, including topics that interest them, concepts in school subjects, and contemporary issues. Students listen to words, phrases, and passages in the target language in order to identify standard pronunciation and to improve their reading comprehension. Students listen to explanations of language structures and conventions and cultural concepts. They also

listen to a wide range of oral texts representing formal and informal social registers and various genres and forms appropriate to their interests (e.g., podcasts, videos, song lyrics, radio shows, electronic sources, poetry, short stories, advertisements, video games, radio shows). They also need exposure to oral texts of increasing difficulty in the target language, such as longer radio broadcasts or documentaries on more complex topics.

It is important that teachers contextualize listening interactions and activities for students. This can be done through brainstorming to identify what students already know about the topic of a new text they are about to hear or view. Some examples of richly integrated tasks are: discussing strategies for organizing ideas for a writing assignment; presenting and defending ideas or debating current issues; and offering constructive and descriptive feedback about work produced by their peers.

## Speaking

Oral language is a fundamental means of communicating with others and the cornerstone of learning in all areas. Students build a broad range of speaking skills, both for conversational purposes and for academic purposes, such as presenting ideas and information to their classmates. At first, students engage in brief conversations on everyday topics; as they progress, they engage in speaking tasks such as sharing ideas about a variety of texts in a literature circle; and eventually, they are able to present classroom seminars or participate in debates.

International language learners need rich and frequent opportunities to speak and interact in the classroom in a purposeful way – for example, through collaborative learning in pairs and small groups that allows them to engage in speaking and listening for real-life purposes. Through multiple opportunities to speak in various groupings, students begin to communicate effectively and to gain confidence as they explore ideas and concepts, identify and solve problems, organize information, and express and clarify their thoughts, feelings, and opinions. An opportunity for self-reflection about their speaking skills and strategies enables students to strengthen their ability to express themselves and interact with other speakers of the target language.

It is important that teachers not only offer instruction and feedback, but also provide excellent models of the competence that a first-language speaker would demonstrate in speaking for both academic and social purposes. Teachers at all course levels should also provide modelling of various special sound features of the international language, and include instruction on norms and conventions associated with speaking the language in different cultures.

## Reading

This strand provides extensive opportunities for students to build on their experience in listening to and speaking the target language to help them determine the meaning of written texts in the target language. Students read a wide variety of adapted and authentic literary, informational, and graphic texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. They activate their background knowledge, acquire vocabulary, think aloud about what they are reading, discuss texts with peers, and participate in group reading and learning activities. An effective reader not only grasps the ideas communicated in a text but is able to apply them in new contexts. To do this, the student must be able to think clearly, creatively, and critically about the ideas and information encountered in texts. The student can then understand, analyse, and absorb them and recognize their relevance in other contexts. The international languages curriculum develops the knowledge, strategies, and skills that will enable students to become effective readers in the target language.

As learners develop their reading skills in the target language, it is important that they have many opportunities to read a wide variety of texts from diverse cultures and for a variety of purposes. By reading widely, students will develop a richer vocabulary, become more attuned to the language structures and conventions of the target language in various genres, and increase their understanding of diverse world views.

Reading is a complex process that provides a bridge between speaking and writing. Students learning to read in the target language are also acquiring knowledge of new vocabulary and language structures, as well as a new phonological awareness of the sound system of the target language. Reading also involves the application of many comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading. Teachers need to model the use of such strategies, engage students in shared and guided exploration of texts, and foster the independent application of reading strategies. Students need to identify which strategies are personally most helpful and how they can use these and other strategies to improve as readers. For example, students might prepare before reading by identifying the purpose of the reading activity and by activating their prior knowledge about the topic of the text and the vocabulary contained in that text.

During reading, students may use clues from context or from their understanding of language elements and structures to help them determine the meaning of unfamiliar words. They will also use a variety of comprehension strategies such as predicting, questioning, identifying main ideas, and monitoring comprehension to help them understand a text. After reading, students may analyse, synthesize, make connections, evaluate, and use other critical and creative thinking skills to achieve a deeper understanding of the material they have read. For example, students might evaluate an author's perspective or bias in a piece of writing and discuss how that might affect the reader's interpretation.

To become fluent readers of the target language, students need to read frequently and develop the range of skills required to read for a variety of different purposes – to follow directions, to get advice, to obtain information, to build vocabulary, to obtain access to subject knowledge, and for personal interest and enjoyment.

It is important that students read a range of authentic materials illustrating the many uses of writing, since these texts will serve as models for texts that they will create. The reading program should therefore include a wide variety of literary, informational, fictional, and graphic texts – for example, short story, myth, legend, folk tale, poem, song, novel, play, report, newspaper or magazine article, television or radio script, manual, advertisements, autobiography, chart, diagram, graphic novel, comic book, recipes, and instructions.

## Writing

From their experience with oral communication and reading, students acquire the skills they need to become good writers who are able to communicate ideas and opinions with ease and clarity. Current research confirms the similarity in the writing processes of both first- and second- language writers. The elements that go into writing in any language are essentially similar: selecting a topic; organizing and developing ideas to be included; choosing the form of writing and level of language appropriate to the audience and the purpose for writing; applying the conventions of written language such as grammar, spelling, punctuation, and word choice; and applying editing, revising, and proofreading strategies to produce a polished piece of writing.

However, for students who are learning a second language, the planning stage of the writing process is critical. Students must become skilled at choosing the correct vocabulary in the target language,

while selecting and organizing their ideas. They must also keep in mind the purpose for which they are writing and the audience they are addressing. To communicate clearly and effectively, they need to learn to use standard written forms and the language conventions of the target language.

Students who are beginning to write in the target language need to read a wide variety of texts that expose them to uses of vocabulary, grammatical elements, and idioms that they will need when writing their own texts. As students read a variety of written texts, they not only increase their vocabulary but also learn to vary their sentence structure, their organizational approach, and the voice they use in their writing. Students should produce a variety of forms or types of writing, such as descriptions, letters, journal entries, advertisements, brochures, summaries, reviews, dialogues, poems, short stories, questionnaires, newspaper articles, essays, and reports. Students should be given opportunities to produce interactive writing, different types of creative writing, as well as writing that addresses topics of interest to them and reflects their capacity for independent critical thought. Writing activities that are seen by students as meaningful and that challenge them to think critically and creatively will help them achieve a fuller and more lasting command of the essential skills of writing. Students' writing activities, in turn, support and reinforce both their oral language skills and their reading skills.

In addition, all students, whether they are writing in their first language or any other language, need to be taught ways to avoid plagiarism when writing for reporting and research purposes.

For more information about effective instruction in the four strands, consult the ministry resource document entitled *Adolescent Literacy Guide: A Professional Learning Resource for Literacy, Grades 7–12, 2013*.

# International Languages, Level 1

Academic

LBABD – LDYBD

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This course provides opportunities for students to begin to develop and apply skills in listening, speaking, reading, and writing in the language of study. Students will communicate and interact in structured activities, with a focus on matters of personal interest and familiar topics, and will read and write simple texts in the language. Throughout the course, students will acquire an understanding and appreciation of diverse communities in regions of the world where the language is spoken. They will also develop skills necessary for lifelong language learning.

**Prerequisite:** None

# A. LISTENING

## OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. Listening to Understand:** determine meaning in a variety of oral texts in the target language, using a range of listening strategies;
- A2. Listening to Interact:** interpret messages accurately while interacting in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- A3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in oral texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

## SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

### A1. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

#### A1.1 Using Listening Comprehension

**Strategies:** identify a range of listening comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after listening to understand simple oral texts in the target language (e.g., brainstorm about the topic before a listening task to make connections to prior knowledge and personal experiences; make and verify predictions about the content of a song or of a poem or story read aloud to confirm understanding; use visual and contextual cues to aid comprehension while viewing a multimedia text or a target-language play; use a teacher-prepared checklist to identify key ideas while listening; identify cognates and familiar words and phrases to help them interpret a speaker's message; ask questions to clarify or confirm important details after listening to a text)

**Teacher prompts:** “Before beginning this listening task, think about what you already know about the topic. List your ideas in a graphic organizer of your choice, such as a K-W-L chart.” “Think about visual or contextual cues that helped you understand what you heard during the play. What gestures, for example, did the actors make that explained a new word or expression?”

**A1.2 Demonstrating Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and meaning of oral texts in the target language that contain information about matters of personal interest and familiar topics, with contextual and

visual support (e.g., follow oral directions to find a specific classroom object; identify the main message of, and new vocabulary in, a dialogue, a song, or an audio webcast; summarize key information in a brief oral report about technology use in schools, using words, pictures, or actions; identify vocabulary related to time, days, months, and numbers in a recorded message about train schedules, and classify it using a graphic organizer; determine the meaning of new words in a dramatization of an authentic conversation in a restaurant; identify the cost of an item for sale at a market or store)

**Teacher prompts:** “As you listen to this report, think of symbols or actions that can represent its key ideas. What images best communicate the message?” “Listen closely to the details in this recorded message. How can you organize them by time, date, and number?” “What new words did you hear in the conversation?”

### A2. Listening to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

#### A2.1 Using Interactive Listening Strategies:

identify and use a range of interactive listening strategies to suit a variety of situations while participating in structured interactions in the target language (e.g., use and respond to visual cues such as nodding, head shaking, and facial expressions indicating agreement or lack of understanding; acknowledge and build on the ideas of others in paired and small-group exchanges on familiar topics; use vocal prompts to signal interest during a discussion; use respectful body language

to help give another speaker confidence during group work; alternate listening and speaking; ask a speaker to slow down)

**Teacher prompts:** “What kinds of visual cues might you use to indicate agreement or lack of understanding during an interaction?” “How can you show that you are listening with interest? Give some specific examples.”

**A2.2 Interacting:** respond with understanding to what others say while participating in brief, structured interactions in the target language about themselves, family, friends, and their immediate environment, with contextual and visual support (e.g., in pairs and small groups, answer questions on familiar topics; offer additional ideas in response to a peer’s plan for a waste-free lunch; use information a peer has provided in an interview to introduce him or her to a group; with a peer, role-play an interaction about shopping for electronics; agree or disagree with a partner verbally and non-verbally in a conversation about a new technology they have used; agree or disagree with a partner on which of two or more items to buy at a supermarket, based on a prescribed budget, and justify their choice)

**Teacher prompts:** “What questions can you ask to be sure that you understand your peer as you share information with each other?” “As you prepare for the role play, think about the questions you might have to answer when either making a purchase or working in an electronics store. What key phrases will you listen for to respond correctly?”

### A2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe some strategies they found helpful before, during, and after listening;  
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as listeners, and plan steps they can take to improve their listening skills (e.g., plan to keep a journal of helpful listening strategies for future reference; plan to act on feedback from a peer in order to self-monitor listening comprehension; describe steps they can take to become more engaged listeners; identify and describe listening strategies that helped them interact effectively during a class discussion; identify strategies that help them assess their comprehension after a listening task; identify distractions or other factors that might impede their listening comprehension, and describe some ways to minimize those factors)

**Teacher prompt:** “How might you check to be sure you understand what you have heard? What questions can you ask yourself?”

## A3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

**A3.1 Intercultural Awareness:** using information from oral texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., on a map of Ontario, Canada, or the world, locate communities where the target language is spoken after listening to directions or to audio-visual sources of information; listen to audio or audio-visual media and identify information indicating the status of the target language in Canada, such as the number of people who speak it as their first language; listen to a peer’s description of a holiday or cultural event in a target-language community and relate it to an event in their own community; identify and share the main theme of a target-language play; listen to a media clip describing family customs in a target-language community and make connections to their own family customs; estimate the salaries of various employees in a target-language community after listening to a description of their job responsibilities and comparing them to similar jobs in the Ontario workplace)

**Teacher prompt:** “When you heard your peer describe a tradition in the target-language community, how did it remind you of one of your own traditions? What were some of the similarities?”

### A3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:

using information from oral texts in the target language, identify and demonstrate an understanding of sociolinguistic conventions used in a variety of situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (e.g., infer the social context from a speaker’s use of formal or informal forms of address; identify expressions of courtesy such as greetings and farewells; identify common target-language expressions and compare them to similar expressions in English, French, or their first language; compare the body language of speakers engaged in the same kind of social interaction in a target-language community and their own community; after listening to a dialogue, identify various ways to express gratitude)

**Teacher prompt:** “What new expressions have you heard target-language speakers use that you can add to your vocabulary list? What are some similar expressions in English, French, or your first language?”

## B. SPEAKING

### OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Speaking to Communicate:** communicate information and ideas orally in the target language, using a range of speaking strategies, appropriate language structures, and level-appropriate language suited to the purpose and audience;
- B2. Speaking to Interact:** participate in spoken interactions in the target language for a variety of purposes and with diverse audiences;
- B3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their spoken communications in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

### SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

#### B1. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

##### B1.1 Using Oral Communication Strategies:

identify a range of speaking strategies and use them to express themselves clearly and coherently in the target language for various purposes and to a variety of audiences (e.g., *identify and/or clarify the purpose for speaking; when planning an oral presentation, use a template to outline key information and supporting details associated with their topic; use body language and physical proximity to connect with their audience; adjust speaking pace to hold a listener's attention; use visual aids to support an oral presentation; use modelled or familiar sentence patterns and vocabulary when presenting information orally; while delivering a presentation, use rhetorical patterns such as repetition and familiar words and phrases to help their audience identify key points*)

**Teacher prompts:** “Once you have gathered information for your presentation, think about the main message you want to express. How might you use the template to sort points according to their relevance to your topic?” “What can you convey to an audience with your body language and physical proximity?” “How does repeating certain phrases throughout your presentation help your audience? What kinds of phrases might you choose to repeat?”

**B1.2 Producing Oral Communications:** produce brief, rehearsed messages in the target language to communicate information about matters of personal interest and familiar topics, with contextual, auditory, and visual support (e.g., *introduce themselves, family members, and/or pets; describe how to perform an action or find an object; deliver a presentation on daily routines, a hobby, sport, celebrity, film, or type of music, using visual aids and a script; recount a sequence of events from a fictional or news story; deliver an oral report on an environmental issue such as the impact of climate change; compose and deliver the narration for a slideshow; report the findings of a survey of peers' musical preferences; explain the cost and purpose of each item in a budget they have created for a minor event such as a birthday party*)

**Teacher prompts:** “As you give directions, think about how many steps are needed. How can you make sure that your instructions are clear?” “As you prepare a presentation about your daily routines, think about the last week. How did you begin each day? What was your favourite part of the day?”

**B1.3 Speaking with Fluency:** speak with a smooth pace, appropriate intonation, and standard pronunciation in brief, rehearsed communications in the target language about a variety of familiar topics (e.g., *accurately pronounce high-frequency and familiar vocabulary when discussing their interests; accurately pronounce*

*vocabulary modelled by the teacher when giving prepared responses; express preferences and requests smoothly; recite a familiar poem, pausing as indicated by the punctuation; deliver a presentation with appropriate phrasing and emphasis)*

**Teacher prompt:** “As you prepare to recite the poem, think about how you will refer to the punctuation when deciding where to pause and for how long. How will the pauses affect your listener and influence your delivery?”

**B1.4 Applying Language Knowledge:** use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their meaning clearly in the target language

## B2. Speaking to Interact

By the end of this course, students will:

**B2.1 Using Conversation Strategies:** identify and use a range of conversation strategies to suit a variety of structured, guided, formal, and informal situations while participating in simple spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., use non-verbal cues such as facial expressions and gestures to clarify their meaning for the other participants in group work; acknowledge the contributions of others during a class discussion; make personal connections to the experiences of others when responding during a class discussion; use target-language expressions meaning “What do you think?” or “I’d like to add” to signal turn taking during a small-group discussion*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What are some different ways to acknowledge other people’s contributions to a discussion?” “What might you do to indicate politely that you’d like to take your turn to speak during a group discussion?”

**B2.2 Interacting:** engage in brief, structured spoken interactions in the target language about matters of personal interest and familiar topics, with teacher modelling and support (*e.g., offer and respond to greetings; ask and respond to simple questions about age, family, favourite school subjects, the weather, holidays, music, dance, leisure activities, and places in the community; with a peer, role-play a telephone conversation about a school project; with a partner, role-play ordering a healthy meal in a restaurant; compare likes and dislikes with a peer; exchange information about technology-related careers in a small-group discussion; exchange information*

*with a peer about what can go into a recycling bin in the classroom or at home; brainstorm with the whole class to create a shopping list and budget for summer holiday or back-to-school shopping)*

**Teacher prompt:** “What things do you and your partner both like to do in your free time? What chores do you dislike? What are some questions you can ask to learn more about him or her?”

### B2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe some strategies they found helpful before, during, and after speaking to communicate effectively;  
(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as speakers, and plan steps they can take to improve their speaking skills (*e.g., describe the strategies they find most helpful to consolidate new speaking skills; plan to reflect on feedback from peers and the teacher on revising the content of their spoken messages; identify the most effective speaking strategies used by a peer in a presentation, and plan to incorporate one of them into their own presentation*)

**Teacher prompts:** “When you learn a new speaking skill, how can you ensure that you maintain and build on it?” “What kind of feedback about your spoken messages do you find helpful? What kinds of revisions can you make in response?”

## B3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

**B3.1 Intercultural Awareness:** communicate information orally in the target language about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (*e.g., identify a significant individual who speaks the target language and describe some of his or her accomplishments; share with a peer some naming practices and traditional nicknames, including names/naming ceremonies in First Nations communities; describe a region or community where the target language is spoken, using a brochure they have made or found to illustrate their remarks; sing, retell, or paraphrase a target-language song, story, or legend; describe the cuisine or meal-time customs of a target-language community, and compare them with examples from their own community; describe the traditional clothing, dances, or music of a target-language community and compare them with traditional Inuit clothing, dances, or music;*

*plan and estimate the costs of a sightseeing tour in a city where the target language is spoken, making comparisons to the costs of a similar tour in their own community)*

**Teacher prompts:** “What are the most impressive accomplishments of this individual?” “Describe some meal-time customs of the target-language community. In what ways are they similar to your own?” “How much does a visit to a museum in your own community cost? How can you find the cost of a similar visit in the target-language community?”

### **B3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:**

identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in spoken interactions in the target language (*e.g., use forms of address and expressions of greeting, leave*

*taking, and courtesy that match the formality of the interaction; use contextually appropriate gestures and other forms of non-verbal communication, such as shrugging, bowing, shaking hands, and greeting someone with a kiss on the cheek or in the air; use conventional speech formulas to initiate, interrupt, and conclude conversations politely; incorporate familiar idiomatic expressions into a dialogue; identify and describe some alternatives to standard vocabulary, such as regional variations)*

**Teacher prompts:** “Why is it important to know your audience when choosing how to address or greet people or how to signal leave taking? Can you give an example of when you would, or wouldn’t, use a certain way of saying goodbye?” “What expression might you use to begin a conversation? What might you say to end the conversation politely?”

# C. READING

## OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Reading Comprehension:** determine meaning in a variety of texts in the target language, using a range of reading comprehension strategies;
- C2. Purpose, Form, and Style:** identify the purpose(s), characteristics, and aspects of style of a variety of adapted and authentic text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms;
- C3. Intercultural Understanding:** demonstrate an understanding of information in texts in the target language about aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language used in a variety of situations and communities.

## SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

### C1. Reading Comprehension

By the end of this course, students will:

#### C1.1 Using Reading Comprehension Strategies:

identify a range of reading comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after reading to understand simple texts in the target language, in modelled, shared, guided, and independent reading contexts (*e.g., preview vocabulary to identify familiar words and cognates; use an anticipation guide to predict the content of a text, and verify their predictions while reading; make connections between personal experience and specific ideas in a text to extend their understanding; refer to text features such as images, captions, headings, and tables to get a sense of the topic and structure of the text; create a list of questions to clarify their understanding of the topic; create a list of key words in a text, and refer to them when summarizing its message*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What text features can help you to get a sense of the topic before you read? What does the picture tell you about the text, for example?” “Think of other texts similar to the one you have just read. Do they help you understand this text? How?”

#### C1.2 Reading for Meaning:

demonstrate an understanding of information and ideas in simple texts in the target language, with teacher support as appropriate (*e.g., retell a story read in class, using a storyboard; dramatize key elements of a report about a current event or a social or an environmental issue; summarize information in a*

*brochure about adolescent health; identify and record key information and supporting details from brochures or posters; follow written directions to locate an object; read song lyrics and interpret the theme using dance; compare the prices of items in a menu, catalogue, or flyer expressed in Canadian dollars and in the currency of the target-language community*)

#### C1.3 Reading with Fluency:

read texts in the target language that contain familiar vocabulary and expressions at a sufficient rate and with sufficient ease to demonstrate that they understand the overall sense of the text (*e.g., read aloud with suitable expression, pausing as indicated by the punctuation and using appropriate emphasis; smoothly articulate high-frequency words and words related to personal interests while reading aloud; use intonation to distinguish the character when participating in a readers’ theatre; identify and accurately pronounce the same word in different reading contexts, such as on a word wall or in shared-, guided-, and independent-reading activities*)

**Teacher prompts:** “How does paying attention to punctuation help you make your reading sound more like speaking?” “Think about the emotions that the text implies. How can you convey them as you read aloud?”

#### C1.4 Developing Vocabulary:

use a range of vocabulary-acquisition strategies before, during, and after reading to determine or confirm the meaning of new, unfamiliar, or recently learned words (*e.g., use knowledge of roots, prefixes, and suffixes to infer the meaning of unfamiliar words;*

identify cognates while reading, and keep a list for future reference; consult a target language–English dictionary while reading to confirm or revise their interpretation of unfamiliar words; create a list of personally relevant words from a variety of reading sources to refer to as a memory aid; compile a list of key themes and concepts after reading to consolidate their vocabulary acquisition; compile a list of the names and associated symbols of currencies used in target-language communities around the world)

**Teacher prompts:** “Describe some techniques for remembering new words or expressions you encounter when reading. Which one do you find most helpful?” “How does knowledge of word parts, such as prefixes, suffixes, and roots, help you understand unfamiliar words?”

## C2. Purpose, Form, and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

### C2.1 Purposes and Characteristics of Text

**Forms:** identify the purpose(s) and characteristics of some familiar text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how the characteristics help communicate the meaning (e.g., *verse in a greeting card commemorates an event or conveys thanks; the interplay of images and words on a poster communicates information in a concise and memorable way; setting, plot, and characterization work together in a short story to depict the significance of imagined experiences; a magazine article answers the questions who, what, when, where, how, or why to outline arguments about its subject*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What is the intention of the text? What is its message?” “What are some differences between a greeting card and a poster in terms of the way each communicates its message?”

### C2.2 Text Features and Elements of Style:

identify some features and stylistic elements of familiar text forms, including fictional, informational, graphic, and media forms, and explain how they help convey the meaning (e.g., *rhyme patterns and descriptive words in a poem evoke an emotional response; a list of ingredients, quantities, and procedural steps guide the cook through a recipe; photographs, captions, headings and subheadings, sidebars, and pull quotes direct the reader’s attention to information in a magazine article; a subject line, a salutation, emoticons, and a signature provide key information in an e-mail; alphabetical order in an encyclopedia helps the reader find information; links in a website lead the user to related information*)

**Teacher prompts:** “Why is it conventional to provide a list of ingredients before the directions

in a recipe?” “What text features draw the reader’s attention to key information in this magazine article? What makes them effective?” “What type of information do emoticons communicate in an e-mail?”

### C2.3 Metacognition:

(a) describe some strategies they found helpful before, during, and after reading to understand texts;

(b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as readers, and plan steps they can take to improve their reading skills (e.g., *keep a reading log and use it to track their reading trends; identify which strategies are useful at particular stages of the reading process; rank their top five reading comprehension strategies in order of effectiveness; compare top strategies with those of a peer and collaborate to describe the best use for each; plan to skim texts to identify their features or find unfamiliar words to look up; plan to incorporate vocabulary they have newly acquired from reading sources into spoken and written contexts*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What strategy do you find effective to help you prepare to read a text? What makes it useful?” “What strategy do you use to check your comprehension after reading? Why?”

## C3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

**C3.1 Intercultural Awareness:** using information from a variety of texts in the target language, identify communities where the target language is spoken, find out about aspects of their cultures, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., *locate target-language communities in Canada using census data; research traditions and festivals in target-language communities and report to the class; select programs of interest from a television schedule in the target language; read about significant individuals from target-language communities, and describe some of their accomplishments; find a comic strip in the target language that illustrates an aspect of culture, and explain it to the class; read target-language song lyrics and compare them with lyrics written in their own first language; read about an environmentally significant area in a target-language community and explain its significance*)

**Teacher prompts:** “Where can you begin your research about a target-language tradition or festival that interests you?” “How does this comic strip explore an aspect of life in the target-language community? Do you think it is effective? What did you learn from it?” “What ideas in the song lyrics seemed similar to ideas

you've read in lyrics in your first language? Did any of the expressions in the target-language lyrics surprise you? Why?"

**C3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:**

identify, in level-appropriate texts in the target language, examples of sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken (*e.g., distinguish between expressions commonly used in business and personal letters and/or e-mails; identify and describe the level of formality typically used in target-language social networking; identify some vocabulary used in a magazine interview by a person who speaks a regional variation of the target language; read target-language song lyrics and identify expressions used in a particular region*)

*Teacher prompt:* "What are some words and expressions commonly used in social networking? How can you tell whether they are formal or informal?"

# D. WRITING

## OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form:** write texts in the target language for different purposes and audiences, using a variety of forms and knowledge of language structures and conventions of the written language appropriate for this course;
- D2. The Writing Process:** use the stages of the writing process – including pre-writing, producing drafts, revising, editing, and publishing – to develop and organize content, clarify ideas and expression, correct errors, and present their written work in the target language effectively;
- D3. Intercultural Understanding:** in their written work in the target language, demonstrate an awareness of aspects of culture in diverse communities where the target language is spoken and other communities around the world, and of the appropriate use of sociolinguistic conventions in the target language in a variety of situations.

## SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

### D1. Purpose, Audience, and Form

By the end of this course, students will:

#### D1.1 Identifying Purpose and Audience:

determine, with support from the teacher, their purpose for writing and the audience for texts in the target language they plan to create (*e.g., to provide personal information on an application for a summer job or a registration form for an extracurricular activity; to send greetings to a friend, family member, or teacher in a postcard; to describe personal preferences and interests to a pen pal by letter; to record daily activities in a personal diary for their own interest; to prepare for a class discussion about a fictional character by creating a word web; to compose an e-mail inviting friends or relatives to a celebration; to create a simple budget for a day trip to tourist attractions in a target-language community*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What is the typical purpose of writing a postcard? How can you adapt the language to the person who will receive it?” “How does your purpose for writing affect your choice of form?”

- D1.2 Writing in a Variety of Forms:** write a variety of level-appropriate texts in the target language, applying their knowledge of the basic structural and stylistic elements of each form (*e.g., a postcard to a friend describing a*

*vacation; a survey or questionnaire on an environmental issue; a paragraph describing a person they admire or the ideal friend; a product manual with steps, techniques, diagrams, and captions; a brief report detailing their weekly spending*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What kind of information should you include in a postcard?” “What adjectives best describe the personality of your ideal friend? What activities would that person enjoy?” “What elements of a manual help you describe how to use a product?”

- D1.3 Applying Language Knowledge:** use language structures and conventions appropriate for this course (see the Language Knowledge chart for international languages in Appendix B) to communicate their intended meaning in written work in the target language

### D2. The Writing Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1 Generating, Developing, and Organizing Content:** generate, develop, and organize ideas for writing in the target language, using some pre-writing strategies and resources, during modelled, shared, guided, and independent writing activities (*e.g., brainstorm in a small group to activate prior knowledge about a writing*

topic; gather ideas for writing from read-alouds and shared reading activities; construct a concept web to explore the scope of a topic; compile a list of vocabulary related to the assigned topic; use timelines and charts to record, sort, and classify information; participate in a conference with peers and the teacher to clarify their thinking about a topic; use an outline to help them structure ideas)

**Teacher prompts:** “What personal experiences and prior knowledge can you refer to as you develop a list of possible writing topics?” “Try describing to a peer two different possible ways to write about your topic. Which one does he or she prefer? Why? What other approach or ways to modify one of your ideas can your peer recommend?”

**D2.2 Drafting and Revising:** plan and produce drafts in the target language following a model, and revise their writing using a variety of strategies, with teacher support (e.g., consult a teacher-prepared template or model while structuring their draft; use a teacher-prepared checklist to confirm they have edited all the elements of their draft; reread a draft to determine whether to add, delete, or reorder information; use teacher feedback to help them improve the organization of their draft; invite feedback on their written work in an authors’ circle, and consider it when making revisions to clarify the message; while writing a draft, consult resources such as a word wall, dictionaries, and online references to confirm spelling and enrich their vocabulary; add information to ensure that their ideas are adequately developed)

**Teacher prompt:** “What kinds of revisions do you find you need to make after rereading your draft? Do you see any patterns?”

**D2.3 Producing Finished Work:** make improvements to enhance the clarity and readability of their written work in the target language, and use some elements of effective presentation to produce a polished product for publication (e.g., add high-frequency adjectives of colour, quantity, location, and sentiment to engage the reader; check that their use of punctuation is correct; add headings to draw the reader’s attention to main ideas; label the significant components of a diagram; use graphic elements such as labelled diagrams, textboxes, and illustrations to support key ideas)

**Teacher prompts:** “What visual elements could you add to support your message and appeal to the reader?” “What organizational elements can you use to highlight key ideas and information?”

## D2.4 Metacognition:

- (a) describe some strategies they found helpful before, during, and after writing;
- (b) identify their areas of greater and lesser strength as writers, and plan steps they can take to improve their writing skills (e.g., reflect on and select the pre-writing strategies that are best suited to a particular task; keep a list of new and interesting words and ideas to use in future writing tasks; plan to use a graphic organizer before writing to rank their ideas in order of importance or to identify their logical sequence; plan to use peer and teacher feedback to help them identify gaps in the information presented in their rough draft; describe the benefits of sharing their ideas about writing topics with a peer or in a small group)

**Teacher prompts:** “Which strategy do you find most helpful for organizing information before you begin writing?” “When you are having difficulty putting your ideas into a logical sequence, what strategy might you use to determine the best order?”

## D3. Intercultural Understanding

By the end of this course, students will:

**D3.1 Intercultural Awareness:** in their written work in the target language, communicate information about communities where the target language is spoken, including aspects of their cultures and their contributions to the world, and make connections to personal experiences and their own and other communities (e.g., compare the education systems in various target-language communities using a T-chart; write a letter to an imaginary or a real friend in a country or region where the target language is spoken, asking questions about tourist attractions or eco-tourism; write a paragraph explaining the origins and meaning of target-language names; create a poster advertising a destination where the target language is spoken; write a blog entry summarizing interesting and important facts about a target-language community; write an e-mail to a tourism bureau inquiring about student rates for tourist attractions)

**Teacher prompt:** “What would you like others to know about this community? What interesting facts about it can you include in your poster?”

**D3.2 Awareness of Sociolinguistic Conventions:** identify sociolinguistic conventions associated with a variety of social situations in diverse communities where the target language is spoken, and use them appropriately in their

written work in the target language (e.g., *introduce themselves using conventional expressions in an e-mail to a potential exchange partner; use the appropriate level of formality in a letter to an expert requesting information on a topic being studied; use target-language date, number, and currency formats correctly in a receipt or an invoice; use appropriate salutations and closings in informal letters, postcards, e-mails, and text messages; write a thank-you note using expressions of gratitude and appreciation*)

**Teacher prompts:** “Why is it important to adjust the formality of your written language according to the reader?” “What examples can you give of familiar or informal expressions that you use when writing to a friend?”